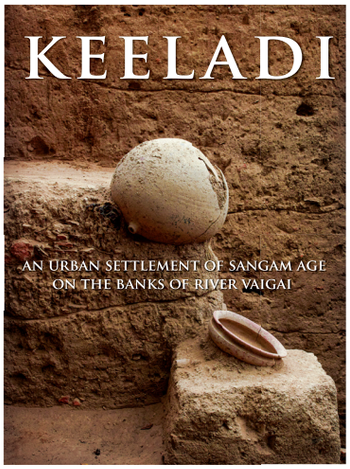


Highlights of the Keeladi Excavations conducted by the Department of Archaeology, Government of Tamil Nadu.

Six carbon samples collected from the fourth season (2018) of excavations at Keeladi were sent to Beta Analytic Lab at Miami, Florida, USA for AMS dating. The results reveal that the sample collected at a depth of 353cm goes back to 580 BCE .

LITERACY

Potsherds inscribed with Tamil-Brahmi script have been unearthed. One of these dated to 580 BCE indicates the high literacy level of Tamil people by sixth century BCE


Graffiti


kuviraṉ-āta[ṉ]

AGRICULTURE AND CATTLE REARING


Bos indicus


Horns

The Post-graduate and Research Institute, Deccan College, Pune, based on its lab test of 70 samples of animal skeletal fragments, collected from Keeladi, has identified the following species: Cow/Ox (*Bos indicus*), Buffalo (*Bubalus bubalis*), Sheep (*Ovis aries*), Goat (*Capra hircus*), Nilgai (*Boselaphus tragocamelus*), Blackbuck (*Antilope cervicapra*), Wild boar (*Sus scrofa*) and Peacock (*Pavo cristatus*).

CONSTRUCTION TECHNOLOGY

Bricks unearthed in Keeladi are similar in sizes to that of other excavated sites of the Sangam Age with the ratio of 1:4:6. This reveals that the Tamils had mastered construction technology.


Brick Walls


Spindle Whorls

WEAVING INDUSTRY

Discovery of 180 spindle whorls, 20 sharpened bone tips (used in pre-historic times as needle to make designs on clothes), hanging loom weights made of stone or baked clay, copper needle, reveals the engagement of people in cloth making at different stages of spinning, warping, weaving and dyeing.

COMMERCE

Excavation has brought to light beads of agate and carnelian. Raw materials for the making of these beads may have been brought from North West India through Maharashtra and Gujarat.

Red earthenware unearthed in Keeladi are akin to Arretineware used in Rome in 2nd century BCE.


Agate and Beads


Rouletted ware (Indigenous)

11th_History_English Medium_History_Unit 5.indd 70 10-02-2023 12:47:52